

Chapter 42-8

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On the other side of the city, Memory Restaurant.

After Xu Qingzhu finished eating with Sally and Cherry, they sat there chatting for a while.

Talking about everything under the sun.

Work had finally ended, so they could finally relax a bit.

Sally slammed the table and said: "I want to go clubbing!"

Cherry: "You can tell you're not a decent person."

Sally: "?"

"To be fair, you've been clubbing more times than me." Sally defended herself, "And I go to proper places."

Cherry: "What you're talking about was in the past. I haven't been to those kinds of places since graduating from university—too noisy."

Sally was left speechless by this response and indignantly sought arbitration from Xu Qingzhu.

Xu Qingzhu spread her hands, "I think what Sally said is right, and Cherry isn't wrong either. Those who like clubbing can go clubbing, those who like wellness can do wellness. All's well that ends well."

Sally and Cherry looked at her in unison, "Fence-sitter!"

Xu Qingzhu smiled.

There was no helping it.

Who told these two to always argue over meaningless little things?

Cherry also discussed future work plans with Xu Qingzhu. She could help Xu Qingzhu for about another year. After Xu Qingzhu established herself at Minghui or successfully revived Minghui, she would start her own independent studio. Xu Qingzhu expressed complete understanding.

Sally, on the other hand, would always stay at Minghui.

In her words, working anywhere was still working.

After they finished chatting, they got up, and Xu Qingzhu paid the bill.

After leaving the restaurant, Xu Qingzhu told the two of them to wait in the lounge area while she went to use the restroom.

Sally suddenly patted Cherry: "Look, isn't that Junior Weiwei?"

"Still calling her junior?" Cherry rolled her eyes, "Just a little white lotus¹."

Sally: "..."

She didn't dwell on that term anymore, but excitedly said: "She went to the same place as Blanche!"

Cherry was very calm, "There's only one restroom. What's strange about going to the same place? Anyway, Haizhou City is only so big—they'll run into each other sooner or later."

Sally: "..."

Instantly calmed down.

Xu Qingzhu didn't know that Bai Weiwei had also come to this mall and had dined at the same restaurant.

But when she came out, she saw Chen Liuying.

She wore a black mask, and because her face was small, some skin showed on both sides of the mask, appearing whiter than when she'd seen her before.

She had dyed her hair a new color—yellowish.

The kind of yellow that would look very ugly without sufficiently fair skin.

But Chen Liuying pulled it off well.

However, Xu Qingzhu didn't like her, and by extension disliked her looks.

No matter how beautiful she was, she was just a "phoenix vase²."

After hearing what Lin Luoxi had told her, Xu Qingzhu was even more convinced this was just a parasite sucking blood from Bai Weiwei.

She had tried sending text messages to Bai Weiwei before, but they all sank without a trace.

Now that they met, there wasn't much to say.

But while she was washing her hands, Chen Liuying suddenly came over, pressing her body against Xu Qingzhu's back, saying in a low voice: "You're Xu Qingzhu, right? You're very beautiful."

Xu Qingzhu frowned and directly elbowed her, but this didn't make her body move away. Instead, she leaned in closer, laughing softly in her ear: "You're even more beautiful in person than in videos. But why aren't you wearing that black tight top? That would make your figure more... taut."

As she spoke, her gaze also wandered toward Xu Qingzhu's chest.

This was unbearable.

Xu Qingzhu pushed her away, directly shoving her against the wall.

Even pressed against the wall, she still didn't forget to take verbal advantage, "I was complimenting you, darling. You really are beautiful."

Xu Qingzhu frowned in disgust: "Does Weiwei know how disgusting you are?"

Chen Liuying smiled, "People all like beautiful things. I'm just appreciating beauty. Why would that be disgusting?"

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

As she spoke, she leaned toward Xu Qingzhu, who directly pushed her away. As a result, she was shoved against the wall, her head even hitting it, making a very heavy thudding sound.

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That didn't make sense.

She didn't have that much strength at all.

What followed was an angry shout, "Xu Qingzhu, what are you doing?"

Xu Qingzhu turned around to see Bai Weiwei storming over angrily, "Even if you have issues with me, you don't need to physically assault her, do you?"

Xu Qingzhu went from initial bewilderment and shock to helplessness in less than half a minute.

"I didn't hit her." Xu Qingzhu explained.

"I saw it all!" Bai Weiwei said: "Having Liang Shi steal Chen Liuying's role wasn't enough for you, now you have to assault people when you meet them? Are you still the Xu Qingzhu I know? Why aren't you pretending anymore? Where's your aloofness? Does this place allow you to hit people?!"

"I said I didn't hit anyone." Xu Qingzhu said: "Weiwei, don't you believe me?"

"Why should I believe you?" Bai Weiwei looked at her with disgust, "I saw the moment you struck."

"But didn't you see her sexually harassing me?" Xu Qingzhu confronted her, "Chen Liuying came over first to flirt..."

"Ha." Bai Weiwei sneered, "Xu Qingzhu, just how many more lies are you going to make up? You really will stop at nothing to achieve your goals."

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

She gave up arguing with Bai Weiwei and turned to leave, but Bai Weiwei grabbed her wrist, "Stop right there."

Xu Qingzhu frowned and turned back, "What?"

Bai Weiwei paused, but said firmly: "Make Liang Shi give up the role of Han Sui."

"What?" Xu Qingzhu was shocked.

"I said, you make Liang Shi give up the role of Han Sui, or I'll post the video of what you just did online." Bai Weiwei said: "Your Minghui Jewelry, which just got a new lease on life, will fall into another public opinion crisis because of your behavior. And Liang Shi's career will be stillborn before it even starts. You know the power of the internet—it's more terrifying than either of us can imagine."

Xu Qingzhu stared at her, her eyes showing shock, incomprehension, and pain.

She couldn't understand why a friend who had once been so close could become what she was now.

But after a moment, Xu Qingzhu shook her head, "No, Liang Shi would never give up this role."

"As long as you ask, she'll do it." Bai Weiwei said: "I know she listens to you very much now."

Xu Qingzhu closed her eyes, then said firmly: "But I won't make her give up."

"This is something she worked hard to fight for. I won't let down her efforts."

Footnotes: ¹ White lotus: Chinese internet slang for someone who appears innocent and pure on the surface but is actually manipulative ² Phoenix vase: Someone who is beautiful but useless, like an ornamental vase